2.3.3 Enter, update, and exit

You've used the `.enter()` behavior of a selection many times already. Now let's take a closer look at it and its counterpart, `.exit()`. Both of these functions operate when there's a mismatch between the number of data values bound to a selection and the number of DOM elements in the selection. If there are more data values than DOM elements, then `.enter()` fires, whereas if there are fewer data values than DOM elements, then `.exit()` fires, as in figure 2.24. You use `selection.enter()` to define how you want to create new elements based on the data you're working with, and you use `selection.exit()` to define how you want to remove existing elements in a selection when the data that corresponds to them has been deleted. Updating data, as

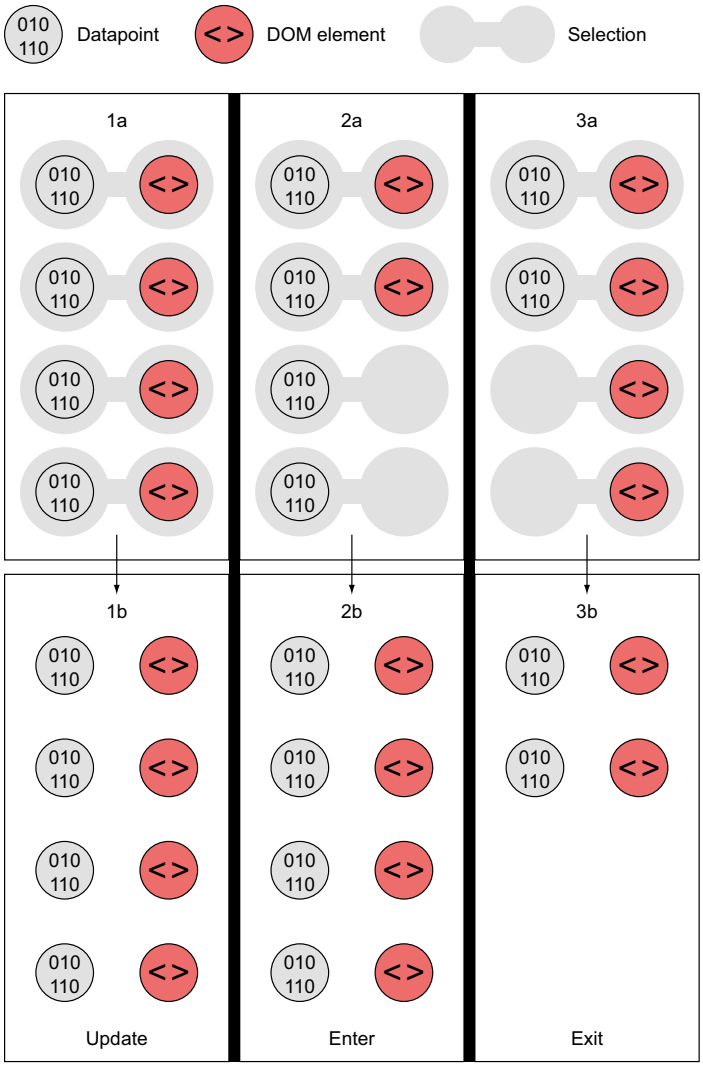


Figure 2.24 Selections where the number of DOM elements and number of values in an array don't match will fire either an `.enter()` event or an `.exit()` event, depending on whether there are more or fewer data values than DOM elements, respectively.